RESEARCH COMPANION



Care Ethics & AI Alignment

Annotated bibliography and source-quality audit for “Relational Paradigms in Artificial Intelligence.”

COVERAGE	47 citations reviewed
PURPOSE	Summarize contribution, relevance, and evidentiary limits
PREPARED	11 October 2026

Source audit at a glance

The report rests on a credible scholarly core, but its reference list mixes peer-reviewed research and canonical philosophy with tertiary explainers, duplicate access points, and five citations that should be removed or replaced.

GRADE	ASSESSMENT	COUNT	MEANING
A	Strong	**19**	Peer-reviewed or canonical primary source
B	Useful	**15**	Scholarly synthesis, academic record, institutional study, or credible project source
C	Limited	**8**	Tertiary, commentary, duplicate access point, or non-peer-reviewed proposal
D	Remove / replace	**5**	Irrelevant, generic, duplicate homepage, or non-source

Highest-priority correction

Do not describe the reported 23.4% reduction in instrumentally convergent behavior as definitive proof. The cited source is the Alignment Ethics Institute's own research page; treat it as a project-reported finding until methods, data, and independent replication are examined.

How to read the grades

A sources can carry major claims when cited precisely. **B** sources are useful for framing or project-specific claims. **C** sources should not carry contested evidence. **D** sources should be removed or replaced.

Scope

Annotations evaluate how each item functions in the supplied report. Selected key sources were checked directly; other entries are assessed from the report's citation information and their source type. This is not a full systematic review.

Editorial rule

For empirical claims, cite the original study. For conceptual claims, cite canonical works or peer-reviewed scholarship. Use news, encyclopedia, and project pages only to orient readers or attribute claims to their originating organization.

Core AI alignment and care

1–4

01

B · Useful

El Masri, R., & Snoswell, A. “Towards Attuned AI: Integrating Care Ethics in Large Language Model Development and Alignment.” SoLaR Workshop at NeurIPS, 2024.

openreview.net

A workshop paper that directly argues care ethics can correct overgeneralization and narrow normative assumptions in reinforcement learning from human feedback. It is the report’s best conceptual bridge between care ethics and large language model alignment. Use it for the report’s central thesis, but describe its operational proposals as an agenda rather than validated engineering results.

02

A · Strong

Rathje, W. “Learning When Not to Measure: Theorizing Ethical Alignment in LLMs.” AIES 2024.

ojs.aaai.org

A peer-reviewed conference paper on limits of quantification and conflicts among normative theories in language-model alignment. It supports the report’s critique of reducing ethical judgment to comparable scores. The work is primarily theoretical, so it should not be cited as empirical proof that care-oriented alignment improves model behavior.

03

A · Strong

Kimani, R. W. “Care Ethics and the Transformation of Care in an Age of Artificial Intelligence.” 2026.

pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov

A peer-reviewed conceptual analysis applying Tronto’s phases of care to healthcare AI and social robots. It is a strong source for the report’s claim that AI reorganizes rather than replaces moral labor, and for the “moral crumple zone” discussion. Its method is normative and illustrative, not a clinical outcome study.

04

C · Limited

“Forms of Algorithmic Bias.” Artificial Intelligence and Ethics, Idaho Pressbooks.

idaho.pressbooks.pub

An open-textbook chapter useful for orienting readers to common forms of algorithmic bias. It can support definitions and classroom-level explanation, but should not carry novel or contested empirical claims. Replace it with original studies when specifying the prevalence or effects of a particular bias.

Foundations of care ethics

05

C · Limited

“Ethics of Care.” New World Encyclopedia.

newworldencyclopedia.org

A tertiary overview of the tradition, its major figures, and common contrasts with rule- and outcome-based ethics. It is suitable for preliminary orientation only. The report should prefer canonical texts or peer-reviewed reference works for claims about Gilligan, Noddings, Held, and Tronto.

06

B · Useful

Sander-Staudt, M. “Care Ethics.” Internet Encyclopedia of Philosophy.

iep.utm.edu

A scholarly reference entry that maps the field’s genealogy, concepts, objections, and political expansion. It is a strong secondary source for definitions and intellectual context. Because it synthesizes rather than advances original research, it should be paired with primary texts for close philosophical claims.

07

C · Limited

“Ethics of Care.” Wikipedia.

en.wikipedia.org

A tertiary orientation source that can help locate names and topics but is not stable enough for substantive support. Its inclusion weakens the bibliography when stronger philosophy references are already present. Remove it from the final scholarly reference list or use it only as a private discovery aid.

08

A · Strong

Held, V. The Ethics of Care: Personal, Political, and Global.

voidnetwork.gr

A canonical monograph extending care ethics beyond intimate relationships into political and global life. It supports the report’s critique of the autonomous liberal individual and its account of interdependence. Cite the published book edition in the bibliography; this hosted PDF is useful for access but is not the preferred bibliographic record.

Foundations of care ethics

09

B · Useful

Sander-Staudt, M. “Care Ethics.” Course-library PDF.

syllabus.pirate.care

A substantial scholarly overview that appears to duplicate much of the conceptual role served by the Internet Encyclopedia of Philosophy entry. It is useful for historical and thematic framing. Consolidate citations 6 and 9 unless distinct passages are required, and verify publication metadata before a formal academic citation.

10

A · Strong

“Navigating Ethical Complexity: Moral Development in Pediatric Oncology Nursing.” Nursing Ethics.

ovid.com

A peer-reviewed nursing study relevant to moral development in a care-intensive clinical setting. It can illustrate how contextual, relational judgment operates in practice. Its pediatric oncology focus is narrower than AI alignment, so any transfer to model design should be framed as analogy rather than direct evidence.

11

C · Limited

“Virtue Ethics and Ethics of Care.” Introduction to Philosophy, Pima Open Press.

pimaopen.pressbooks.pub

An introductory textbook chapter clarifying differences and overlaps between virtue ethics and care ethics. It is useful pedagogically but adds little evidentiary weight to the report. Prefer the canonical and peer-reviewed sources already present for claims about care as a distinct normative theory.

12

B · Useful

“Feminist Ethics.” Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy.

plato.stanford.edu

A high-quality scholarly reference on feminist ethical traditions and their critiques of abstraction, hierarchy, and exclusion. It strengthens the report’s placement of care ethics within feminist philosophy. As a secondary synthesis, it should contextualize rather than substitute for the primary works of Gilligan, Noddings, Held, Tronto, and Kittay.

Foundations of care ethics

13 B · Useful

“Ethics in Artificial Intelligence: Introduction to the Special Issue.”

researchgate.net

An academic overview of major ethical questions raised by artificial intelligence. It provides broad field context but is not specific to care ethics or relational alignment. The report should use it sparingly and cite the journal version rather than the ResearchGate landing page when publication details are available.

14 B · Useful

“The Ethics of Care and Participatory Design: A Situated Exploration.” University of Texas repository.

repositories.lib.utexas.edu

A repository-hosted academic work connecting care ethics with situated, participatory design. It supports the report’s argument that affected people should shape system design and evaluation. Verify the author, degree or venue, and year from the document before formal citation; repository location alone does not establish peer-review status.

15 A · Strong

“Aging and Caring Architecture: A Theoretical Approach.” MDPI.

mdpi.com

A peer-reviewed theoretical article extending care ethics into architecture and aging. It helps demonstrate that relational care can inform socio-technical environments beyond one-to-one interaction. Its relevance to AI alignment is indirect, so it works best as an interdisciplinary example rather than a foundation for technical claims.

16 B · Useful

Hind, S. “Cartographic Care, or Care-tographies.” 2022.

samhind.com

An academic paper applying care to mapping and spatial practices. It broadens the report’s treatment of care as an infrastructural and situated activity. Because its domain is cartography rather than AI, the report should make the transfer argument explicit and avoid presenting it as direct evidence about model behavior.

17

A · Strong

Tronto, J. C. Moral Boundaries: A Political Argument for an Ethic of Care.

scribd.com

A canonical book that develops care as a political practice and grounds the phases of attentiveness, responsibility, competence, and responsiveness. It is central to the report's governance framework. Cite the official book edition rather than the Scribd copy, and distinguish Tronto's original four phases from later extensions.

18

A · Strong

"Care Ethics in Transnational Healthcare: Attentiveness, Competence ..." 2024.

tandfonline.com

A peer-reviewed article applying care-ethical concepts to transnational healthcare. It offers a useful account of attentiveness and competence under institutional and cross-border complexity. The report can use it to show care ethics at system scale, while avoiding claims that it directly validates AI-specific interventions.

Data, design, and structural power

19

B · Useful

Gray, J., & Witt, A. “A Feminist Data Ethics of Care for Machine Learning: The What, Why, Who and How.” ResearchGate record.

researchgate.net

A duplicate or alternate access point for the First Monday article listed next. The paper is highly relevant because it translates care into questions about data practice, power, and responsibility across machine-learning lifecycles. Retain the journal version as the canonical citation and remove this duplicate.

20

A · Strong

Gray, J., & Witt, A. “A Feminist Data Ethics of Care for Machine Learning: The What, Why, Who and How.” First Monday.

firstmonday.org

A peer-reviewed article that operationalizes feminist care ethics for machine-learning data work. It is one of the report’s strongest sources for connecting abstract relational values to concrete design and governance practices. Use this version instead of the ResearchGate duplicate and capture full publication metadata.

21

A · Strong

“Addressing the Promise and Peril of AI for Nonprofit Management.” 2025.

tandfonline.com

A peer-reviewed article on organizational opportunities and risks of AI in nonprofit settings. It supports the report’s claim that care-oriented governance must address institutional incentives and stakeholder vulnerability. Its nonprofit-management setting limits generalization to frontier-model alignment, so use it for deployment governance rather than technical safety claims.

22

D · Remove / replace

“Joanne Gray.” ARDC Research Link Australia.

status.researchdata.ardc.edu.au

An author or researcher directory record, not a research source. It may help confirm identity or affiliations but cannot support the report’s substantive claims. Remove it from the bibliography and cite the author’s actual publication instead.

Data, design, and structural power

23

A · Strong

“Working with Intersectional Critical Concepts in Machine Learning.” FAccT 2022.

facctconference.org

A peer-reviewed FAccT paper on translating intersectional critical concepts into machine-learning work. It strengthens the report’s analysis of power, categorization, and partial perspectives. The paper is adjacent to care ethics rather than solely about it, so the report should explain how intersectionality complements relational attentiveness.

25

B · Useful

“ME: Modelling Ethical Values for Value Alignment.” University of Southampton ePrints.

eprints.soton.ac.uk

An academic repository paper on computationally representing ethical values for alignment. It is relevant to the move from normative theory to reward or decision structures. Verify venue and review status before treating results as established, and keep distinct the modeling of ethical values from evidence that a system genuinely cares.

24

A · Strong

“More-than-Human Ethics for Social Work.” 2026.

tandfonline.com

A peer-reviewed article extending ethical concern beyond exclusively human relationships. It supports the report’s brief discussion of posthumanist and ecological care. This is a peripheral theme in the report, so one concise citation is sufficient; it should not distract from the human vulnerability and accountability argument.

Simulated empathy and mental-health risk

26

B · Useful

“The Compassion Illusion: Can Artificial Empathy Ever Be Emotionally Authentic?” Frontiers in Psychology, 2025.

frontiersin.org

A published opinion article arguing that artificial systems can simulate empathic expression without intentionality, embodiment, or moral participation. It directly supports the report’s “deceptive empathy” analysis. Because it is explicitly an opinion piece rather than an empirical study, use it for conceptual framing and pair it with behavioral or clinical evidence.

27

A · Strong

“How LLM Counselors Violate Ethical Standards in Mental Health Practice: A Practitioner-Informed Framework.” AIES.

ojs.aaai.org

A peer-reviewed conference paper evaluating language-model counselors against practitioner-informed ethical standards. It is a strong source for the report’s five failure themes and warnings about context, collaboration, discrimination, deceptive empathy, and crisis handling. Confirm the exact study design and sample before quoting prevalence or effect sizes.

28

C · Limited

“AI Therapist? It Falls Short, a New Study Warns.” Powers Health, 2026.

powershealth.org

A health-system news summary of research on AI therapy limitations. It can make findings accessible but should not serve as the principal evidence because details may be compressed. Replace it with the underlying study wherever the report makes a specific empirical or clinical claim.

29

C · Limited

“AI Counselors Cross Ethical Lines.” Psychiatrist.com.

psychiatrist.com

A professional-news account of ethical concerns about AI counselors. It is useful for communicating the practical significance of research, but it remains a secondary summary. Cite the original AIES paper for methods and results; keep this only if the report needs an accessible practitioner-facing interpretation.

Simulated empathy and mental-health risk

30 **A · Strong**

“How Generative AI Fosters Therapeutic Misconception in Vulnerable Users.” Frontiers in Digital Health, 2026.

frontiersin.org

A peer-reviewed article focused on users misperceiving generative systems as therapeutic agents. It supports the report’s concern that conversational fluency can create false expectations of care, competence, and duty. It is especially relevant to disclosure, interface design, and safeguards for vulnerable users.

31 **B · Useful**

Brown University. “New Study: AI Chatbots Systematically Violate Mental Health Ethics.” 2025.

brown.edu

An institutional news release summarizing university-affiliated research. It is a credible pointer and offers accessible context, but it is not a substitute for the underlying scholarly paper. Use the primary study for formal claims and this source only for communication or institutional context.

32 **D · Remove / replace**

“Just King Achievement Guide.”

sanandres.uep.edu.py

The title and host do not indicate a meaningful connection to care ethics, AI alignment, or mental-health safety. It appears irrelevant or mistakenly captured. Remove it unless a manual review reveals a specific, defensible role that the current citation label fails to show.

33 **D · Remove / replace**

“Search Result for ‘Review.’” Dove Medical Press.

dovepress.com

A generic search-results page rather than a stable publication. It cannot support any claim and gives readers no identifiable work to inspect. Replace it with the specific article that the original research intended to cite.

Simulated empathy and mental-health risk

34

A · Strong

“Empathy AI in Healthcare.” PubMed Central.

pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov

A peer-reviewed, open-access healthcare article on artificial empathy. It is relevant to the report’s comparison of perceived compassion and authentic care. Check whether the cited numerical claim about response length and compassion ratings comes from this article, and cite the exact study passage rather than attributing broadly.

35

A · Strong

“Artificial Intelligence Connectedness: Theoretical Reconstruction of ...” Behavioral Sciences, 2026.

mdpi.com

A peer-reviewed theoretical article on human-AI connectedness. It supports discussion of parasocial bonds and the reconstruction of connection through AI systems. Its theoretical framing should be separated from clinical evidence about harm, dependency, or social displacement.

Operational frameworks and governance

36

C · Limited

“AI Alignment Proposal #7: Bottom-Up Virtue Ethics: A New Approach.” Medium.

medium.com

A public proposal suggesting bottom-up virtue learning as an alternative to purely rule-based ethics. It is useful as an idea source for simulation and reward design, not as evidence that the approach works. The report currently gives the proposal more technical authority than its publication status warrants.

37

A · Strong

Sonnenberg, L. K., et al. “Principles for Responsible AI in Health Professions Education, Research, and Care: Health CARE-AI Framework Delphi Consensus Study.” JMIR Medical Education, 2026.

mededu.jmir.org

A peer-reviewed, three-phase modified Delphi study with 303 unique contributors and a final set of ten consensus principles. It is a strong, actionable source for contextual, accountable, responsible, and equitable AI in health settings. It establishes expert consensus, not clinical effectiveness, and should be described accordingly.

38

C · Limited

“The Relational Care-AI Alignment Framework: An Ethical Model for Artificial Intelligence Involvement in Person-Centred Fundamental Care.” ResearchGate record.

researchgate.net

A ResearchGate access point for the nursing framework listed next. It is redundant and may not preserve authoritative metadata. Remove this duplicate and cite the journal or PubMed record.

39

A · Strong

Xia, L., et al. “The Relational Care-AI Alignment Framework: An Ethical Model for Artificial Intelligence Involvement in Person-Centred Fundamental Care.” Journal of Advanced Nursing, 2026.

pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov

A peer-reviewed discursive review proposing three zones of AI involvement based on relational dependency and five ethical principles. It provides a practical heuristic for preserving person-centered nursing relationships. The framework did not include patient or public participation, and it should not be presented as validated outcome evidence.

Operational frameworks and governance

40

D · Remove / replace

“WOMBAT Tool Configuration.” ResearchGate figure page.

researchgate.net

A figure page with no clear relationship to the report’s care-ethics argument. A screenshot record is not an adequate citation for a framework, method, or result. Remove it or replace it with the complete article if WOMBAT is genuinely relevant.

41

A · Strong

“Textual and Comparative Analyses on AI Policies: How Big Tech …” 2025.

tandfonline.com

A peer-reviewed comparative policy analysis of major technology companies. It can support claims about how corporate AI policies encode values and governance priorities. It is not specific evidence for care ethics unless the report explicitly connects its findings to relational accountability.

42

B · Useful

Vallor, S. The AI Mirror: How to Reclaim Our Humanity in an Age of Machine Thinking. ResearchGate record.

researchgate.net

A scholarly book arguing that AI reflects human data, institutions, and moral choices rather than possessing independent wisdom. It is central to the report’s warning against outsourcing agency and accountability. Cite the publisher’s book edition for formal bibliography; the ResearchGate record is only an access point.

43

B · Useful

“Managing Through the AI Mirror.” University of Auckland Executive Education.

exec.auckland.ac.nz

A university-based management interpretation of Vallor’s “AI mirror” argument. It can translate philosophical concerns into organizational practice, but it is secondary commentary. Use Vallor’s book for the core thesis and this page only for applied management framing.

Operational frameworks and governance

44

A · Strong

“A Situated Reflection on the Simulation of Historical Figures.” Open Library of Humanities.

olh.openlibhums.org

A peer-reviewed article on situated knowledge and the simulation of historical figures. It is relevant to the report’s concern about partial data being presented as universal or disembodied knowledge. Its case is specialized, so the report should clearly state the analogy to broader AI alignment.

45

B · Useful

Tang, A., & Green, C. “Civic AI: 6-Pack of Care.”

civic.ai

A governance toolkit translating care into six practical tests: attentiveness, responsibility, competence, responsiveness, solidarity, and symbiosis. It is valuable for deployment checklists and contestability. The site explicitly presents an evolving research project, so do not describe the framework as peer-reviewed or empirically validated.

46

B · Useful

Alignment Ethics Institute. “Research & Publications.”

alignmentethics.org

A primary project page reporting a 19-model identity study and a 24-model InstrumentalEval benchmark, including the report’s cited 23.4% average reduction in instrumentally convergent behavior. This is the correct place to attribute those project claims. Independent replication or a peer-reviewed paper is still needed before calling the result definitive.

47

D · Remove / replace

Alignment Ethics Institute. Home page.

alignmentethics.org

A general institutional homepage that duplicates the research-page citation without identifying a specific publication. It adds no evidentiary value. Retain citation 46 and replace this entry with a direct paper, dataset, or methods page if one becomes available.

Recommended citation practice

Next revision

1. **Anchor the argument in nine core sources.** Prioritize citations 1, 3, 8, 17, 20, 27, and 37–39 for the report's conceptual, clinical, and operational claims.
2. **Separate theory from evidence.** Care ethics can motivate design principles without proving that a model is safer; empirical benchmark claims require methods, datasets, effect estimates, and replication.
3. **Collapse duplicates.** Keep 20 instead of 19, keep 39 instead of 38, and keep 46 instead of 47. Cite official journal or publisher records rather than ResearchGate or document-sharing copies.
4. **Remove unusable entries.** Delete 22, 32, 33, and 40 unless a manual source check identifies a specific relevant work.
5. **Qualify source status.** Label workshop papers, opinion articles, Delphi consensus studies, discursive reviews, project websites, and preprints accurately; none is equivalent to replicated outcome evidence.
6. **Repair bibliographic metadata.** Add authors, years, journal or publisher, volume/issue, pages, and DOI where available. Several current entries are only page titles and URLs.

Bottom line

The literature supports care ethics as a serious lens for contextuality, vulnerability, relational accountability, and deployment governance. The stronger sources do not yet establish that care-oriented prompting or training is a mature, general solution to advanced alignment risk.

Source titles and links follow the bibliography supplied in the Gemini report, with obvious line-break artifacts repaired. Grades reflect evidentiary fitness for this report, not an absolute judgment of the authors or venues.